

House Patton

House Patton

"ABOVE HUMAN, BELOW GOD"

Quick Facts

Status: Royal Family of Aicruae / Imperial Family of the Solisian Empire

Origin: Aicruae

House Name Meaning: Victorious (Winner)

Founded: 8,759 BR

Founder: King Haliour Layern Patton I

Active Years:

Seat: Lajazer, Capital City of Aicruae (atop a mountain-like cliff)

Faction: Divine Faction

Spirit Animal: Panther

Colors: Blue (Loyalty & Strength) & Black (Constancy & Grief)

Wealth: ~ 300, 000 Rern (Pre-Empire)

Military: 200,000 soldiers (First Army & Second Army) ranked #2 in Aicruae

Religion: Leneyez

Theme Song: "Legendary" by Welshly Arms

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Status By Era

Pre-Empire Era: Royal Family of Aicruae. The unbroken dynasty that founded and ruled the kingdom for nearly two millennia, from King Haliour I's coronation in 8,759 BR through the reign of King Benjamin Lawrence Patton II.

Solis's Era: Imperial Family. After winning the civil war against his half-siblings Iris and Orcus, Emperor Solis Elias Patton unified Aicruae, Gherci, Coelum, Pireaynea, Equateiy, and Vikistv into the Solisian Empire. House Patton went from ruling one kingdom to ruling the known world.

Crandona's Era: Imperial Family. Still the ruling dynasty, though the empire's internal tensions are building toward the birth of Goteivati III and the coming Dark Ages.

Minara's Era: Imperial Family in name. Emperor Veo Olem Patton sits the throne, but is effectively controlled by Empress Macenja, who is actually the infiltrator Vandrea in disguise.

Nicknames People Call Them During This Era

"The First House"

"The Clan Killers"

"The Wolves of the Mountain"

"The Blood of Razar"

"Lords of the Six Clans" (referencing the clans Haliour I united)

"The High Seat"

"The Old Blood"

"The Cliff Kings" (Lajazer sits on a sheer mountain. Impregnable. Intimidating.)

Why They Matter

House Patton is the spine of the entire series. They founded Aicruae, ruled it for nearly two thousand years, conquered the world under Solis, and then slowly rotted from the inside out. The question that runs through all four books is whether the Patton bloodline deserves its power and what it costs to hold it.

They've produced the greatest rulers in history and the absolute worst. The same house that gave the world Emperor Solis also gave it Goteivati the Damned, who murdered his wife and children and created a culture that worshipped male dominance. The same family that built Lajazer on an impregnable cliff spent generations tearing itself apart from within.

Everyone bows to House Patton. Not from love from obligation and power. That distinction matters, and it's the crack in the foundation that every enemy eventually tries to exploit.

Heraldry

Crest: Per bend sable and azure (diagonally divided, black above and blue below), charged in chief with a golden key and a golden labyrinthine knot. Two sable panthers rampant combatant, each crowned with a golden coronet. In base, a golden eight-pointed star.

Symbolism:

The black field represents constancy and the grief that comes with ruling

The blue stands for loyalty and strength

The diagonal division symbolizes the boundary between burden and duty

The golden key represents the unlocking of divine destiny / access to power / guardianship of the realm.

The labyrinthine knot represents, the complexity of rule.

The paired crowned panthers reflect the prophetic dream of King Haliour Layern Patton I-he saw two panthers fighting on a cliff, surrounded by fire, bleeding gold. When the fight ended, the sun overtook the sky. Their crowns mark their royal nature.

The golden star represents the sun that overtook the sky in the King's dream, symbolizing the golden dawn of House Patton's rule

Motto: "Above Human, Below God." The house stands above mortal concerns yet beneath divine authority.

Power & Influence

Source of Power

The Crown of Aicruae and later the Solisian Empire. Divine right ideology. Nearly two millennia of unbroken rule. Every other noble house must bow to them that's not just some custom, that's law.

Internal Power Structure

House Patton is the royal family, so its power structure follows the traditional line of succession: King/Queen, then heirs (Princes and Princesses), then extended members of the royal family. Unlike other houses where strength or cunning can

elevate a member, House Patton's hierarchy is rigid and formal, which is precisely why succession crises hit them so hard.

Military Forces

Ranked #2 in Aicruae for military strength (second only to House Vika), House Patton commands two exclusive military organizations:

The First Army, soldiers loyal to the crown.

The Second Army, soldiers loyal to the heirs.

Combined: 200,000 soldiers. After Solis's conquest and the eradication of House Vika, House Patton absorbs or disbands Vika's 310,000-strong military, making the imperial army unchallenged.

Lands & Income

Seat: The capital city of Lajazer, built atop a mountain-like cliff, a virtually impregnable location chosen by Haliour I after his prophetic dream.

As the royal family, House Patton holds ultimate authority over all of Aicruae. After Solis's conquest: the entire Solisian Empire (six unified kingdoms). Key industries include royal taxation, crown lands, tribute from vassal houses, and the agricultural wealth of Aicruae itself, a flourishing farming country that ensures consistent income.

Alliances & Rivalries

Allied Houses

House Arvento (Duke/Duchess): The crown's most trusted ally. This alliance dates back to the friendship between King Haliour I and Lenkitta Arvento at the founding of Aicruae. A neutral house, extremely loyal, serving as trusted advisors and scholars to the throne across generations.

House Vika (Duke/Duchess): Marriage alliance through Mihai Julie Vika, who married King Benjamin Lawrence Patton II. House Vika was the crown's strongest military ally and its most dangerous one. King Darien Lacern Patton arranged this marriage specifically because Vika's power had grown to rival the royal family's. The alliance ended catastrophically when the Vika-blooded twins Iris and Orcus launched their civil war against Solis.

House Hige (Baron/Baroness): Connected to the crown through Lady Emillea Hige, concubine of King Benjamin Lawrence Patton II and mother of Emperor Solis. A minor house elevated by proximity to the king, though never truly respected by the other noble families.

House Kulio (Count/Countess): Allied through marriage, Esterica Kulio becomes Solis's first empress.

House Najil: Divine Faction ally. Connected through the marriage of Queen Cecea Sanitte (House Najil) to King Sayero Walica Patton.

House Caraen: Protects the capital city of Lajazer. Founded by Milane Caraen, who was granted nobility by King Haliour Layern Patton II. Deeply loyal, they provide personal knights to the royal family.

Rival Houses

Houses of the Common People Faction, House Leva, House Dajanyi, and House Yurea, are ideologically opposed to the monarchy and the noble class system.

Marriage Alliances

House Vika, House Hige, House Kulio, House Yurea, House Najil, House Liazen, and House Mena.

House Culture

Religion

Leneyez, a sub-religion of the Circle of Eternal Light. Leneyez followers believe in sacrificing both people and farm life to both sets of gods during monthly prayers and festivals. Adherents believe these sacrifices maintain the physical and spiritual well-being of the gods. House Patton also has a special connection to the god Razar, who appeared to King Haliour I in the vision that set him on his path to kingship.

Traditions

House Patton's coronation rites unfold over two days, each element tracing back to King Haliour I's founding vision.

The Climb, On the morning of coronation, the heir ascends the final stretch to Lajazer on foot while the court watches from the cliffs above. Multiple paths exist, ranging from gentle slopes to near-vertical rock faces. The route the heir chooses is noted and remembered. Those who take harder paths earn respect; those who choose easy routes invite whispers that follow them throughout their reign. The ritual reenacts Haliour's rise from bastard orphan to king a reminder that Patton rulers must earn their throne, not simply inherit it.

The Anointing. During the formal ceremony, sacred oil mixed with gold dust is applied to the new monarch's forehead by the highest-ranking priest of Razar. The gold echoes Haliour's dream, where the panthers bled gold and the world turned golden at dawn.

Day of Golden Light. The day after coronation, two panthers are brought before the assembled court. Their behavior is read as an omen for the coming reign. Calm panthers signal stability; aggression warns of conflict ahead. At King Viake Recreadion Patton's coronation, one panther leapt into the crowd of nobles and mauled a man's face. People dismissed it as an accident. After the Massacre of Light, they remembered.

Values

Sacred duty of rule. Hierarchy and ceremony. Divine mandate. Family legacy though that legacy is often complicated by internal conflict. Loyalty and strength.

Reputation

Ambition hidden beneath polite piety. Everyone must bow to them, not from love but from obligation and power. House Patton has produced both the greatest and worst rulers in history, and the other noble houses know it. The Pattons are respected, feared, obeyed but rarely loved.

History

Founding (8,759 BR)

King Haliour Layern Patton I was a bastard born to a man sworn to the gods and a commoner woman. Abandoned at birth and orphaned at twelve, he joined a mercenary group at fourteen. At twenty-two, the god Razar appeared to him in a

vision, showing him his fate as a poor man. When Haliour asked how to change it, Razar told him to become king.

So he did. Haliour killed his mercenary leader, united the clans, defeated the warlord Dures, and married Dures's daughter Walica. He founded Aicruae at age thirty and established House Patton two weeks later. Guided by his prophetic dream of the two panthers, two beasts fighting on a cliff, surrounded by fire, bleeding gold, until the sun swallowed the sky he built the capital Lajazer atop a mountain cliff, a virtually impregnable location symbolizing the Pattons' authority. Then he destroyed all records of life in Aicruae before his dynasty.

Rise to Power

House Patton rose through military conquest during the Warriors' Age. King Haliour I's alliance with Lenkitta Arvento secured internal stability, while marriage alliances with Houses Vika and Hige consolidated power. The house's unbroken dynasty lasted nearly two millennia from the founding of Aicruae in 8,759 BR through the reign of King Benjamin II until Solis expanded the kingdom into an empire encompassing all six nations.

Champions of the Warriors' Age. Survived Bloody Winter (8,259 BR), the first successful coup against the royal family. Withstood the Siege of Highwater (7,463 BR), a major peasant uprising. And under Emperor Solis, unified all six kingdoms Aicruae, Gherci, Coelum, Pireaynea, Equateiy, and Vikistv into the Solisian Empire.

Major Disgraces

The Massacre of Light (8,558 BR): King Viake Recreasion Patton and his queen slaughtered 90,000 followers of the Order of the Pure Ones, devastating the Pure Ones' presence in Aicruae.

The Aicruan Civil War (7, 221 — 7, 217BR) : The royal family torn apart. The twins Iris and Orcus seized power from their half-brother Solis after their father King Benjamin II's death, publicly poisoning Lady Emillea Hige while nine-year-old Solis watched. Five years of devastating war followed.

Emperor Goteivati III "The Damned" (0 AR): Ushered in the Dark Ages. Murdered his wife and children. Renounced Matsiali culture and created Pataouit, an

oppressive ideology that worshipped male dominance and stripped women of all authority.

Key Events Timeline

Founding of Aicruae (8,759 BR) - House Patton creates the nation.

The Massacre of Light (8,558 BR) - King Viake slaughters 90,000 Pure Ones followers.

Bloody Winter (8,259 BR) — First successful coup against the royal family; over 3,000 dead.

Siege of Highwater (7,463 BR) - Peasant uprising inspired by Bloody Winter.

Aicruan Civil War (7,221-7,217 BR) - Solis defeats siblings Iris and Orcus.

Conquest of the Six Kingdoms (7,216-7,163 BR) - Solis creates the unified Solisian Empire.

Birth of Goteivati III (0 AR) - Beginning of the Dark Ages.

Notable Members

Listed across two generational periods documented in the family records.

1st Generation Royal Family (8,759 BR — ~ 8, 409 BR)

Dures Benain (8,824 BR —8, 759 BR) Father of Queen Walica. The warlord defeated by Haliour I during the unification of the clans. His death and his daughter's marriage to his conqueror mark the founding moment of both Aicruae and House Patton.

Tehesti Benain (8,814 BR —8, 779 BR) Mother of Queen Walica. Died at 35.

King Haliour Layern Patton I (8,789 BR —8, 736 BR) Founder of Aicruae and House Patton. The bastard who became king. Born to a man sworn to the gods and a commoner woman, abandoned at birth, orphaned at twelve, mercenary at fourteen. The god Razar appeared to him at twenty-two and told him to take a throne. He unified the clans, defeated the warlord Dures, married Dures's daughter Walica, and built the capital Lajazer on a mountain cliff guided by his prophetic dream of two panthers. He destroyed all records of life in Aicruae before his reign. His alliance with Lenkitta Arvento secured internal stability, and his marriage alliances with Houses Vika and Hige consolidated power. Died at 53.

Queen Walica Kevena Patton (8,779 BR —8, 709 BR) First Queen of Aicruae, Daughter of the warlord Dures, married to the man who killed her father. She bore three children: King Benjaien, Princess Aliedea, and Princess Narseai (who died in infancy at one year old). Died at 70.

King Benjaien Nefest Patton (8,754 BR —8, 674 BR) Son of Haliour I and Walica. Second King of Aicruae. Married Queen Vala Uinara Patton, a distant cousin of his mother. Died at 80.

Princess Aliedea Cawiloan Patton (8,752 BR —8, 703 BR) Daughter of Haliour I and Walica. Married Duke Nayiler Mena, who was given the temporary title of Duke so he could marry a princess. They had twin daughters: Lady Naern Mena and Lady Vaseiula Mena. Died at 49.

Princess Narseai Bekan Patton (8,748 BR —8, 747 BR) Youngest daughter of Haliour I and Walica. Died in infancy at one year old.

Queen Vala Uinara Patton (8,757 BR —8, 715 BR) Wife of King Benjaien Nefest Patton and distant cousin of Queen Walica. Died at 42.

Duke Nayiler Mena (8,747 BR —8, 679 BR) Husband of Princess Aliedea. Given the temporary title of Duke to marry into the royal family. Father of twins Naern and Vaseiula. Died at 68.

King Ilaem Nefest Patton I (8,734 BR —8, 659 BR) Son of King Benjaien and Queen Vala. Third King of Aicruae. Married his sister Queen Cawiloan Heka Patton. Died at 75.

Queen Cawiloan Heka Patton (8,730 BR —8, 640 BR) Daughter of King Benjaien and Queen Vala. Wife of her brother King Ilaem I. Mother of King Haliour II and Princess Asayera. Died at 90.

Lady Naern Mena (8,716 BR —8, 660 BR) First twin daughter of Princess Aliedea and Duke Nayiler Mena. Married Count Jinegi Liazen. Mother of Lady Agari Liazen and Queen Isalian Liazen. Died at 56.

Lady Vaseiula Mena (8,716 BR —8, 692 BR) Second twin daughter of Princess Aliedea and Duke Nayiler Mena. Married Ser Winsafantero Paneta. Mother of Zacareneal Paneta (who died in infancy at age 2). Died at 24.

Count Jinegi Liazen (8,722 BR - 8,660 BR) Husband of Lady Naern Mena. Father of Queen Isalian Liazen and Lady Agari Liazen. Died at 62.

Queen Isalian Liazen (8,670 BR —8, 590 BR) Daughter of Lady Naern Mena and Count Jinegi Liazen. Wife of King Haliour Layern Patton II. Through her, the Liazen and Mena bloodlines merged back into the Patton royal line. Died at 80.

Lady Agari Liazen (8,663 BR —8, 660 BR) Daughter of Lady Naern Mena and Count Jinegi Liazen. Died in infancy at age 3 .

Ser Winsafantero Paneta (8,725 BR —8, 700 BR) Husband of Lady Vaseiula Mena. Father of Zacareneal Paneta. Died at 25.

Zacareneal Paneta (8,707 BR —8, 705 BR) Son of Ser Winsafantero Paneta and Lady Vaseiula Mena. Died in infancy at age 2 .

King Haliour Layern Patton II (8,672 BR —8, 589 BR) Son of King Ilaem I and Queen Cawiloan Heka. Named after his grandfather, the founder. The king who granted Milane Caraen his noble title, founding House Caraen as the capital's protectors. Died at 83.

Princess Asayera Atani Patton (8,674 BR —8, 659 BR) Daughter of King Ilaem I and Queen Cawiloan Heka. Died at 15.

Queen Naila Deyua Patton (8,647 BR —8, 559 BR) Daughter of King Haliour II and Queen Isalian Liazen. Ruled as queen. Married King Consort Teravian Geraser Patton, her own brother. Mother of King Viake Recreadion Patton and Princess Capaillia. Died at 88.

King Consort Teravian Geraser Patton (8,646 BR —8, 577 BR) Son of King Haliour II and Queen Isalian Liazen. King Consort to his sister Queen Naila. Died at 69.

King Viake Recreadion Patton (8,629 BR —8, 552 BR) Son of Queen Naila and King Consort Teravian. The king responsible for the Massacre of Light in 8,558 BR - the slaughter of 90,000 followers of the Order of the Pure Ones. Married Queen Mari of House Liazen. Died at 77.

Princess Capaillia Assontionia Patton (8,619 BR —8, 605 BR)
Daughter of Queen Naila and King Consort Teravian. Died at 14.

Queen Mari Patton/Liazen (8,632 BR - 8,552 BR)
Wife of King Viake Recreadion Patton. Member of House Liazen. Complicit in the Massacre of Light. Died at 80.

Princess Karinoa Nalia Patton (8,611 BR —8, 561 BR)
Daughter of King Viake and Queen Mari. Died at 50.

King Sayero Walica Patton (8,608 BR —8, 533 BR)

Son of King Viake and Queen Mari. Married Queen Cecea Sanitte of House Najil. This marriage connected House Najil directly to the royal line. Died at 75.

Queen Cecea Sanitte Patton (8,618 BR —8, 545 BR)

Wife of King Sayero. Member of House Najil. Died at 73.

King Benjamin Lawrence Patton I (8, 590BR — 8, 515BR)

Son of King Sayero and Queen Cecea. Married Queen Toavaliae Javivata Patton - his own sister. Died at 75 .

Queen Toavaliae Javivata Patton (8,562 BR —8, 513 BR)

Daughter of King Sayero and Queen Cecea. Wife of her brother King Benjamin I. Died at 49.

King Lacaseian Emere Patton (8,544 BR —8, 468 BR)

Son of King Benjamin I and Queen Toavaliae. Died at 76.

Queen Tani Evalia Patton (8,538 BR —8, 459 BR)

Daughter of King Benjamin I and Queen Toavaliae. Died at 79.

2nd Generation Royal Family (7,400 BR - 7,163 BR)

King Ilaem Nefest Patton II (7,408 BR —7, 338 BR)

Named after the earlier King Ilaem I. Husband of Queen Rayaliem. Died at 70.

Queen Rayaliem Tani Patton (7,402 BR - 7,370 BR)

Wife of King Ilaem II. Died at 32.

King Vaeric Nefest Patton (7,373 BR - 7,305 BR)

Son of King Ilaem II and Queen Rayaliem. Married Caelindra Hessa, a princess of Gherci a foreign match meant to cement peace between Aicruae and Gherci after a border dispute. Died at 68.

Caelindra Hessa Patton (7,369 BR - 7,301 BR)

Princess of Gherci | Wife of King Vaeric

A foreign match meant to cement peace between Aicruae and Gherci after a border dispute. Caelindra struggled to adapt to Aicruae customs and was considered cold and distant by the court, though her letters reveal a woman deeply homesick and misunderstood. Her foreign blood became a point of contention when succession questions arose later. Died at 68.

King Jesuin Walica Patton (7,343 BR - 7,274 BR)

Son of King Vaeric and Caelindra. Married Queen Yaseira Neacei of House Mena. They had four children, though only Darien survived to adulthood. Died at 69.

Queen Yaseira Neacei Patton (7,340 BR - 7,268 BR)

Wife of King Jesuin | From House Mena

Yaseira was anything but weak. A skilled hunter and horsewoman, she reportedly outshot her husband at their wedding tournament. Their marriage was passionate but volatile - full of legendary arguments and equally legendary reconciliations. She bore him four children, though only Darien survived to adulthood. Died at 72.

Prince Taelivorn Vaericon Patton (7,317 BR - 7,302 BR)

Son of King Jesuin and Queen Yaseira. Died at 15.

Princess Joesindoya Menacae Patton (7,315 BR - 7,306 BR)

Daughter of King Jesuin and Queen Yaseira. Died at 9.

Princess Voesilarae Hessavae Patton (7,309 BR - 7,296 BR)

Daughter of King Jesuin and Queen Yaseira. Died at 13.

King Darien Lacern Patton (7,313 BR —7, 258 BR)

Son of King Jesuin and Queen Yaseira

The only one of Jesuin's four children to survive to adulthood. Married Neliana Uaeran in a love match that scandalized the court, he chose her over three more politically advantageous options. He also made the fateful decision to marry his son Benjamin to Mihai Julie Vika, specifically to keep House Vika loyal as their power had grown to rival the crown's. He never fully recovered from Neliana's early death. Died at 55.

Queen Neliana Uaeran Patton (7,315 BR - 7,276 BR)

Wife of King Darien | From Eastern Aicruae

From the harsher side of Eastern Aicruae, Neliana knew poverty and brutality firsthand. She advocated fiercely for reforms in Haleker and clashed repeatedly with House Vika over taxation of the poor. Her marriage to Darien was a love match that scandalized the court, he chose her over three more politically advantageous options. She died young at 39, and Darien never fully recovered.

King Benjamin Lawrence Patton II (7,284 BR - 7,241 BR)

Last King of Aicruae | Father of the Civil War

Son of King Darien and Queen Neliana. The king whose choices shattered the Patton dynasty. Married Queen Mihai Julie Vika (the political alliance his father arranged), fathered the legitimate twins Iris and Orcus, then took Lady Emillea Hige as his concubine, fathered Solis, and publicly favored the bastard over his trueborn heirs. He named nine-year-old Solis as his heir at the Festival of

Mourning, bypassing Iris and Orcus entirely. He died at 43, four months after making this declaration, and the civil war erupted immediately. Died at 43.

Queen Mihai Julie Patton (7,282 BR - 7,247 BR)

"The Vika Queen" | From House Vika

Only daughter of Duke Rarielo Vika. Married to Prince Benjamin at approximately age 20 in 7,262 BR. The marriage was arranged to ensure House Vika's loyalty to the crown. She bore twin children: Iris and Orcus. When her husband took Lady Emillea Hige as his concubine and fathered Solis, whom he publicly favored Mihai was driven to madness, a decline described as psychosis and schizophrenia precipitated by humiliation at court. She died at 35, six years before her husband and before the twins' coup.

Lady Emillea Hige (7,270 BR - 7,241 BR)

Concubine of King Benjamin II | Mother of Emperor Solis | From House Hige

Her union with the king elevated House Hige's visibility at court considerably her chambers were staffed and decorated in House Hige colors (blue, neon green, orange). After King Benjamin named Solis as heir, Emillea was appointed regent. When the king died four months later, the twins staged their coup. Emillea was captured first. Princess Iris forced her to drink poison in front of a jeering crowd while nine-year-old Solis watched from under a floorboard. Her execution became the defining trauma of Solis's life and the catalyst for the civil war.

Emperor Maen Patton (7,217 BR - 7,140 BR)

Name Meaning: Firstborn Son, Wolf of Heart.

Title: Second Emperor of the Solisian Empire

Parents: Emperor Solis Elias Patton + Empress Esterica Kulio

Spouses: Empress Saiye Patton (first wife), Empress Tenami Patton (second wife), Empress Kesdeivoa Patton (third wife)

Children: None

Born during Civil War Year Five while his parents fought to survive, Maen spent his earliest years in hiding, passed between loyalist households while battles raged across Aicruae. He was young when his father finally claimed the throne and five when his mother died from Harnua's poison. These first years marked him

permanently he learned that the world was violent, that power was survival, and that love was a vulnerability enemies would exploit. He inherited the throne at fifty-four when his father finally died at eighty-seven, and his first act was to rename his father's empire. . Maen ruled in his father's shadow for twenty-three years and never escaped it. The defining tragedy of his reign was his inability to produce an heir. His first wife Saiye gave him fifteen years of marriage and three stillbirths before she died in childbed with a fourth. Tenami, his second wife, was barren from the start or he was, though no one dared suggest it. Kesdeivoa, chosen for her youth and her family's renowned fertility, produced nothing in eight years of marriage. The court whispered that he was cursed. That the gods had looked at what Solis built through blood and decided the line would end. Maen responded to failure the way he responded to everything: with cold fury and calculated cruelty. Physicians who could not explain his wives' barrenness disappeared. Courtiers who whispered too loudly about succession found themselves reassigned to distant provinces. He punished disloyalty with a precision his father would have recognized, but where Solis had been brutal in pursuit of an empire, Maen was brutal in pursuit of control over a court that pitied him. He never forgave his father for dying. Not really. Solis had been the center of Maen's universe the conqueror, the legend, the man who built an empire from the ashes of civil war. When Solis died, Maen discovered that he had spent fifty-four years preparing to be his father's heir and no time at all preparing to be his own man. The empire he inherited was stable, prosperous, and fundamentally Solis's creation. Every decision Maen made was measured against what his father would have done. Every success was credited to Solis's foundation. Every failure was Maen's alone. He grew harder with age. The ambitious young prince who had once dreamed of expanding his father's conquests became a suspicious old emperor who trusted no one and loved nothing. When he died at seventy-seven, childless and largely unmourned, the throne passed to his sister Coyre's eldest son a nephew he had barely acknowledged. The Solisian Empire endured. The Patton dynasty endured. Maen did not.

Princess Coyre Patton

(7,214 BR - ~7,118 BR)

Name Meaning: Heart's Joy

Titles: Princess of the Solisian Empire; Duchess of the Anbai Lands (Gift from Solis for being his firstborn daughter)

Parents: Emperor Solis Elias Patton + Empress Esterica Kulio

Spouse: Duke Shaniser Dajanyi

Children: Emperor Elleinaj Patton I

Coyre was born approximately six months before her mother's death and never knew her. Esterica Kulio the empress who had survived the civil war, who had built libraries and reformed agriculture, who was called "the Mother of a Dynasty" existed for Coyre only as a portrait on a wall and a name spoken with reverence by people who had actually known her. She grew up watching her father mourn a ghost and her brother Maen harden into something cold and ambitious. She learned early that being Esterica's daughter meant being measured against an impossible standard.

When her father married Tixsei Yurea, Coyre was four years old old enough to understand that this new woman was not her mother and young enough to be expected to accept her anyway. Tixsei was kind to her, in the distant way stepmothers are often kind, but Coyre never warmed to her. What she did warm to, unexpectedly, were Tixsei's children.

Snieoa came first a half-sister born when Coyre was six. Then Bier, two years later. They were the children of the second wife, marked from birth as lesser in the succession, and perhaps that's why Coyre claimed them. She had spent her childhood being Esterica's daughter, Maen's sister, Solis's princess roles defined by other people. With Snieoa and Bier, she could simply be Coyre. The older sister who read them stories. Who defended Bier when the other children mocked his weakness. Who let Snieoa follow her everywhere like a small, adoring shadow.

Bier was sickly from the start. A cough that never quite cleared. A pallor that deepened every winter. Coyre spent her adolescence learning which physicians were competent and which were frauds, which herbs eased breathing and which made it worse, which prayers the priests claimed would help and which were empty ritual. She was sixteen when she stopped believing the priests. She was twenty-three when she stopped believing anyone could save him.

Bier died at twenty-two, in a room Coyre had barely left for three weeks. She held his hand when he stopped breathing. She washed his body. She walked behind

his funeral procession with a face so blank that courtiers whispered she felt nothing at all.

She felt everything. She simply decided, in that moment, that she would never show it again.

After Bier's death, the warmth Coyre had shown her half-siblings vanished. Snieoa tried to reach her bringing flowers, suggesting walks, asking to sit together as they once had and Coyre turned her away every time. Not cruelly, not with anger, but with a polite distance that was somehow worse. Snieoa eventually stopped trying. She married Count Atano Yurea, moved to his estates, and built a life that had nothing to do with the sister who had once been her whole world.

Coyre married Duke Shaniser Dajanyi at twenty-five a political match, though not an unhappy one. Shaniser was steady, practical, and intelligent, and he understood that his wife had walls he would never breach. They produced one son, Elleinaj, and raised him with the careful attention of people who knew the succession might one day matter.

It did. When Maen died childless in 7,140 BR, the throne passed to Elleinaj and through him, to Coyre's bloodline. She lived long enough to see her son crowned, to see her granddaughter Cenainaya married to Snieoa's grandson, to see the two branches of Solis's descendants finally reunited. She built a museum in her mother Esterica's honor, commissioned scholars to document Esterica's agricultural reforms and library foundations, and gave Esterica the title she still carries in history: "the Mother of a Dynasty."

She died at ninety-six, sharp-minded to the end, having outlived her father, her brother, her husband, and nearly everyone who remembered the girl she had been before Bier's death. The woman who remained was formidable, accomplished, and utterly alone exactly as she had chosen to be.

Princess Snieoa Patton (~ 7, 208 BR — ~ 7, 131 BR)

Name Meaning: Gentle Rain

Title: Princess of the Solisian Empire (birth); Duchess of the Kaeilen Lands (Gift from Solis, part of her dowry)

Spouse: Count Atano Yurea

Children: Duke Eavanileto Yurea

Snieoa was born into a family that had already decided she did not matter. Her mother Tixsei was the second wife, married after the great Esterica's death, and no child of Tixsei's would ever be measured by anything other than how they compared to Esterica's children. Her halfbrother Maen was the heir, brilliant and cold and already being groomed for empire. Her halvesister Coyre was Esterica's daughter, carrying the weight of that legacy in her very blood. Snieoa was simply the girl who came after pleasant enough, politically useful for a future marriage, but fundamentally unimportant.

She might have believed it, if not for Coyre. Her half-sister claimed her and Bier from infancy, folding them into a world of shared secrets and fierce protection. Coyre was the first person who made Snieoa feel like she mattered for herself rather than for her bloodline. She followed Coyre everywhere as a child, adoring and imitative, and Coyre let her patiently, kindly, in ways that the court found surprising from Esterica's famously composed daughter.

But Coyre was not the center of Snieoa's world. Bier was.

Her brother was two years younger, sickly from birth, and Snieoa appointed herself his protector before she was old enough to understand what protection meant. She fought children who mocked his weakness. She sat with him through fevers, telling him stories to distract from the coughing. She made elaborate plans for their future adventures they would have when he was better, places they would visit, a life outside the suffocating court where no one would care if Bier could not ride a horse. She refused to believe he was dying even when the signs became undeniable.

His death at twenty-two broke something in her. Not visibly Snieoa wept at the funeral and then composed herself, returned to court, continued with her life. But the part of her that had loved fiercely and protected recklessly went quiet. She looked at Coyre across Bier's grave and saw a stranger a woman so controlled, so cold, that Snieoa could not find the sister she had once adored. She tried to reach

her. She brought flowers. She suggested walks. She asked to sit together as they once had, three siblings against a court that undervalued them.

Coyre turned her away. Politely, distantly, with a composure that felt like a door closing forever.

Snieoa stopped trying. She decided, consciously or not, that if Coyre did not want her, she would build a life that did not need Coyre. She married Count Atano Yurea at twenty-six a match that reunited her with her mother's family, giving her a place where being Tixsei's daughter was an asset rather than a liability. She threw herself into the Yurea estates, into her husband's political ambitions, into creating a world where the Patton name was something she carried rather than something that defined her.

She had one son, Eavanileto, and raised him to be everything she wished she could have been confident, healthy, positioned for greatness. When Eavanileto later married Empress Cenainaya, Coyre's granddaughter, Snieoa watched the two branches of her family reunite and felt nothing at all. By then she had spent decades not feeling anything about her siblings. Maen had ignored her existence. Coyre had rejected her grief. Bier was dead.

She outlived Maen by nine years, dying at seventy-seven on her husband's estates, surrounded by grandchildren who knew her only as a composed and practical woman. She did not speak of Bier. She did not speak of Coyre. She had learned, long ago, that some losses were too heavy to carry and too sharp to examine, and she had simply set them down and walked away.

Prince Bier Patton (~ 7, 206 BR — ~ 7, 184 BR)

Name Meaning: Steadfast

Title: Prince of the Solisian Empire

Parents: Emperor Solis Elias Patton + Queen Consort Tixsei Yurea

Spouse: None

Children: None

Biography:

Bier was born struggling to breathe and never stopped. The physicians called it

weak lungs, a constitutional fragility, a tendency toward illness that no amount of care could cure. His mother Tixsei spent his infancy in terror that every cough would be his last. His father Solis when Bier was born, legendary and intimidating visited the nursery rarely and left disappointed each time. A son who could not run, could not train with weapons, could not sit a horse without exhausting himself what use was such a son to an emperor?

Coyre was his refuge. His half-sister was eight years older, the daughter of the great Esterica, and she should have had no reason to care about the sickly child of her father's second wife. But Coyre claimed him anyway, the way she claimed Snieoa, and Bier spent his childhood trailing after a sister who actually looked at him when he spoke. She read to him when he was too tired to read himself. She learned which foods settled his stomach and which made him worse. She argued with physicians on his behalf and won.

He was a gentle child, timid by nature and made more so by a body that betrayed him constantly. The court frightened him the politics, the maneuvering, the way people looked at him with pity or contempt. He preferred small rooms and quiet company. He preferred Coyre and Snieoa, who loved him without expecting him to be strong. He preferred books about faraway places he knew he would never have the health to visit.

Snieoa was his closest friend, two years older and fiercely protective in her own way. Where Coyre was composed, Snieoa was passionate she raged at the children who mocked Bier's weakness, planned elaborate revenges she never carried out, and swore that when she was grown, she would make everyone sorry for how they had treated him. Bier loved her for it, even when her plans embarrassed him. He loved her for seeing him as someone worth defending rather than someone to be pitied.

He knew he was dying long before anyone admitted it. The coughs grew worse in his late teens. The fevers came more frequently. He watched Coyre's face grow more controlled each time she visited and understood what her composure cost her. He tried to be brave for her sake to joke about his condition, to pretend he believed the physicians' reassurances, to act as though he had years left instead of months. He was not sure he succeeded.

He died at twenty-two, in the winter, with Coyre holding his hand and Snieoa weeping in the corner. His last clear thought was that he was sorry sorry for

leaving them, sorry for being the kind of brother who could only be mourned instead of relied upon, sorry for every burden his illness had placed on the people who loved him.

He was buried with full imperial honors, a prince of the Solisian Empire. The funeral was magnificent. Solis did not attend he too frail to travel, they said, though some might suspect his father simply had no interest in mourning a son he had never valued. Maen attended but did not speak to Coyre or Snieoa. The family fractured around Bier's grave, and none of them ever found their way back together.

Emperor Elleinaj Patton I (~7,185 BR ~ 7, 092 BR)

Name Meaning: Eternal Blessing from above

Elleinaj spent his first fifty-five years preparing to be nothing more than a duke's heir. His mother Coyre was a princess, yes, but his uncle Maen was emperor and still young enough still healthy enough that surely the succession would pass to Maen's children. Elleinaj was raised on the Dajanyi estates, educated in administration and diplomacy, groomed to manage lands and negotiate trade agreements. A perfectly adequate future for a perfectly adequate prince.

Then Maen's first wife died without surviving children. Then his second wife proved barren. Then his third wife, year after year, failed to conceive. And gradually, inexorably, the court began to look at Elleinaj.

He did not want the throne. He had met Maen cold, suspicious, cruel to anyone he perceived as a threat and understood that being his uncle's heir meant becoming his uncle's target. Elleinaj cultivated insignificance. He stayed on the Dajanyi estates. He avoided court. He married Banalioya Yurea, a match that connected him to his step-grandmother Tixsei's family but carried no political ambitions. He had one daughter, Cenainaya, and hoped that would be enough.

It was not. Maen died childless in 7, 140BR, and the throne fell to Elleinaj whether he wanted it or not. He was fifty-five years old, entirely unprepared for imperial

rule, and faced with a court full of factions that had spent decades maneuvering for exactly this moment.

He surprised everyone, including himself. The decades he had spent avoiding attention had also been decades spent watching learning how power actually worked, which courtiers could be trusted, which factions would destroy the empire if allowed to dominate. He was not brilliant. He was not charismatic. But he was observant, patient, and genuinely uninterested in cruelty for its own sake, which made him unusual among Patton emperors.

His mother Coyre became his closest advisor, though their relationship remained complicated. She had raised him with the same emotional distance she applied to everything after Bier's death, and Elleinaj sometimes wondered if she loved him or simply recognized his usefulness. He never asked. Asking would have required her to answer, and he suspected both of them preferred not to know.

His greatest achievement was marrying his daughter Cenainaya to Eavanileto Yurea the grandson of his aunt Snieoa, reuniting the two branches of Solis's descendants that had been divided since Bier's death seventy years earlier. The match was politically expedient, dynastically logical, and quietly satisfying to an emperor who had spent his life watching his family fracture. Their son Xayesa would eventually inherit, carrying both Esterica's and Tixsei's blood, finally healing a wound no one had been willing to acknowledge.

Elleinaj ruled for forty-eight years and died at ninety-three, having outlived his mother, his wife, and most of his enemies. Historians remember him as a competent administrator who stabilized the empire after Maen's suspicious reign not a great emperor, but a necessary one. He would have found that assessment entirely accurate and not particularly troubling.

Strengths & Weaknesses

Known For

Nearly two millennia of unbroken rule. Sacred authority. Elaborate ceremony. Producing both the greatest and worst rulers in history. The ultimate political power in Aicruae and, after Solis, the entire known world.

What They Lack

Genuine affection from their vassals, obedience comes from power, not love. Internal family harmony. The Pattons have a pattern of turning on each other that repeats across generations.

Vulnerabilities

Succession crises the civil war between Solis and the twins is the most devastating example, but internal fractures recur throughout the dynasty. Weak kings who allow wives or advisors to truly rule (Viake Recreasion). Deep-seated resentment among the peasantry that periodically erupts (Bloody Winter, Siege of Highwater). In Minara's era: infiltration by Vandrea posing as the Empress, effectively hollowing out the dynasty from within. And a recurring tendency toward obsession whether wielded for good (Haliour II) or evil (Viake).

Role in Narrative

Book 1 (A Tale of a Thousand Songs): Central focus. Solis's civil war against Iris and Orcus. The family is torn apart by King Benjamin II's choices, and the war that follows reshapes Aicruae forever.

Book 2 (A Tale of Three Sisters): Background. The consequences of Solis's empire on the three sisters.

Book 3 (A Princess in Love): Central focus. Crandona's story and the birth of Goteivati III the moment the Patton dynasty begins its descent into the Dark Ages.

Book 4 (Crown of Glory): Central focus. The corrupted imperial family. Emperor Veo is a puppet, Vandrea wears the empress's face, and Minara the hidden Patton princess must reclaim a heritage she doesn't know she has.

Key Members in Story: Book 1: Solis, Iris, Orcus, King Benjamin II, Lady Emillea Hige, Esterica Kulio. Book 3: Crandona, Goteivati III. Book 4: Emperor Veo, Empress Macenja (Vandrea), Prince Elleraian, Minara (secret princess).

Cross-References

House Vika, House Arvento, House Hige, House Kulio, House Najil, House Caraen, House Leva, House Dajanyi, House Yurea, House Mena, House Liazen, House Vemer, King Haliour Layern Patton I, King Benjamin Lawrence Patton II, Queen

Walica Kevena Patton, Queen Mihai Julie Patton, Lady Emillea Hige, Emperor Solis Elias Patton, Princess Iris Aleka Patton, Prince Orcus Emere Patton, Emperor Goteivati III, Esterica Kulio, Crandona, Emperor Veo Olem Patton, Empress Macenja/Vandrea, Prince Elleraian, Minara, Lenkitta Arvento, Milane Caraen, Razar (God), Capital City of Lajazer, Haleker, Eastern Aicruae, The Cidet, Solisian Empire, Aicruae, Gherci, Coelum, Pireaynea, Equateiy, Vikistv, First Army, Second Army, Bloody Winter, Siege of Highwater, Massacre of Light, Order of the Pure Ones, Aicruan Civil War, Battle of Rewqo, Festival of Mourning, Matsiali, Pataouit, Leneyez (Religion), Circle of Eternal Light, Divine Faction, Common People Faction, A Tale of a Thousand Songs (Book 1), A Tale of Three Sisters (Book 2), A Princess in Love (Book 3), Crown of Glory (Book 4)

Keywords

House Patton, Patton, Royal Family, Imperial Family, Aicruae, Solisian Empire, Lajazer, Above Human Below God, Panther, Blue, Black, Leneyez, Legendary, Welshly Arms, Divine Faction,

Rern, First Army, Second Army, King Haliour Layern Patton I, Queen Walica Kevena Patton, Dures Benain, King Benjaien Nefest Patton, Princess Aliedea Cawiloan Patton, Princess Narseai Bekan Patton, Queen Vala Uinara Patton, King Ilaem Nefest Patton I, Queen Cawiloan Heka Patton, Duke Nayiler Mena, Lady Naern Mena, Lady Vaseiula Mena, Count Jinegi Liazen, Queen Isalian Liazen, King Haliour Layern Patton II, Queen Naila Deyua Patton, King Consort Teravian Geraser Patton, King Viake Recreadion Patton, Massacre of Light, Queen Mari Liazen, King Sayero Walica Patton, Queen Cecea Sanitte Najil, King Benjamin Lawrence Patton I, Queen Toavaliae Javivata Patton, King Lacaseian Emere Patton, Queen Tani Evalia Patton, King Ilaem Nefest Patton II, Queen Rayaliem Tani Patton, King Vaeric Nefest Patton, Caelindra Hessa Gherci, King Jesuin Walica Patton, Queen Yaseira Neacei Mena, King Darien Lacern Patton, Queen Neliana Uaeran Patton, King Benjamin Lawrence Patton II, Queen Mihai Julie Vika, Lady Emillea Hige, Emperor Solis Elias Patton, Princess Iris Aleka Patton, Prince Orcus Emere Patton, Emperor Goteivati III, Crandona, Emperor Veo Olem Patton, Empress Macenja, Vandrea, Prince Elleraian, Minara, Bloody Winter, Siege of Highwater, Aicruan Civil War, Conquest of Six Kingdoms, Dark Ages, Matsiali, Pataouit, Razar, Lenkitta Arvento, Milane Caraen, Order of the Pure Ones, Festival of Mourning, Founding of Aicruae